Love Takes Commitment

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Explicit

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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Love Takes Commitment

by Batatadeuces

Summary

As much as they wish being together was enough. There are new obstacles ahead, somehow they have to deal with being a part again and do their best to maintain their love.

Prologue

— **F**or the last time! No way! — Catra snapped. — I'm not accepting his help! How can we even trust this guy? How do we know he is not planning on sabotaging us?!

Catra tried to keep calm when the conversation started but the way Entrapta kept on fighting for it to happen just made her blood boil.

— No? We need him! I don't understand how you said you wanted the fastest and best option and I just handed it to you and you say no?! — Entrapta exasperated.

— Come on Catra. Is the right choice. — Glimmer joined in. — I know it sounds bad but you took a chance on me and look at how far we've come.

Catra glared at them for several seconds, no words, only a burning rage. She closed her eyes and stormed off. She had no way of dealing with the situation and she didn't want to yell at them anymore or even worse, get physical.

All she could think about was getting home. Getting to a safe place.

As she drove away she held back her tears. Adora was working, and Finn was at school. But at least Melog was good company for a crying session.

As she went to unlock the door she was surprised to find it already unlocked. She got in and Adora's scent linger everywhere. She felt an instant relief.

— Dora? — She called trying to figured out where Adora was.

Soon the blonde was coming down the stairs.

— Hey… what are you doing home so soon? — She got closer to kiss Catra but the feline moved to launch herself on the couch.

— Not the best day at work. But before we get into that… is everything okay with you? Why are you home?

Adora sat next to her.

— Oh, nothing. Some kids had a school trip so we decided to cancel the class today…now tell me what's wrong. — She took Catra's hands and started to caress it.

— It's Glimmer and Entrapta… they want us to hire Hordak. They say it is the only way we can get the air clean but I know the only thing he is trying to clean is his name! He just wants publicity and I can't have this motherfucker just coming in the project as if he's some type of fucking hero! — She growled. — They don't understand, they didn't live there, they don't get to say it is fine, he barely dealt with the consequences, he lost his business oh boohoo! I lost my home! — Adora was shocked, nothing came out of her mouth. — I can't do this, I can't have him there.

— Oh man… they really brought him? — Catra nodded. — I'm so sorry. — She pulled Catra closer. — I know it's a tough situation, but I'm sure you're going to make the right decision. I trust you.

Catra soaked in the words. Melog showed up to get in the hug too. The three spent the rest of the afternoon cuddling till it was time to pick up Finn.

X

— So mom… — Finn started and Catra could sense they were about to ask for something. — There's this sleepover happening at Jenna's today, Frosta is going… I know I'm grounded but… can I please go? — They forced an innocent smile. — I promise I'll behave.

Adora didn't dare to speak. Finn had been a little wild with their friends in the past month, and Catra couldn't say that her child wasn't the instigator of the group. Their growing adventurous side made them try to sneak out during one night to grab several balls

that had fallen into the backyard of a neighbor all the kids hate and some feared, said neighbor never gave back the toys and Finn wanted to play hero, as they were the most agile kid in the block. It didn't turn out well.

They fell out of the tree trying to get into the backyard, and somehow still managed to get some of the toys out of there and themselves. But as they knocked on their own front door at 4am with a dislocated shoulder that was nothing to be celebrated. Catra was displeased to say the least. Adora on the other hand thought it was a nice incentive on their part, with a terrible execution.

— You still have a week of chores ahead of you, so you can go today. — Finn cheered. — But I'm so serious when I say this, anything, and I mean anything happens, Finn, and you're not leaving this house until you've graduated. So yeah you're going to behave.

Catra's tone scared both of the blondes on the table.

— Okay… so Frosta said her mom can pick me up. They're leaving already. I'm going to go pack.

The kid left the table in a rush, they had finished eating and we're a bit terrified of Catra.

— Don't forget your toothbrush. — Adora said as they reached the stairs. — And your pillow.

Catra was still too upset about what had happened to ruin Finn's day too, they hadn't done anything terrible but it was so irresponsible Catra couldn't let it slide.

— Are you secretly judging me for letting them go? — The feline asked in a very low tone.

— Never. — She said firmly. — I think it is a good decision.

Catra nodded. As they finished eating someone honked in the front of their house. Finn showed up with a backpack and a pillow in their arms. Catra opened the door to let them go and to wave at Perfuma.

— Behave… I love you.

— I love you too, mom. — They gave her a kiss before running to the car. — Bye Adora! — They screamed before getting in the car.

— Bye! — Adora screamed back.

Catra's ears were not happy at the display.

— Of course you two had to yell. — She mumbled.

They did that almost everyday instead of a normal bye. And Catra was often too close to one of them. It was usually when she dropped Finn at school, but it was worse when she dropped Adora at the gym, Finn was so loud.

— I'll do the dishes. — Adora announced moving away from the door. — You mind preparing the tub for me? — She asked nicely.

— Only if you don't mind me going in with you. — She meant as a way of relaxing but the blushed on Adora's face told her the blonde got a different message from that. — I was kidding, I can wait until you're finished.

Catra walked to the second floor to prepare the bath as she almost face palmed herself. Melog started to follow her around as they always did when Finn wasn't home.

She had promised Adora to not push it. Mostly because all their heated make out sessions were stopped by herself thanks to her feeling weird about having sex in the same roof as Finn. Something Catra was working on. But she could sense Adora was still anxious about it. Especially because there was a very high probability she could think Catra was avoiding her.

As she got down she could sense the difference in mood. Adora had frowned brows.

— I'm done here. — She stated as Catra got closer to the kitchen.

— Can we talk? — The sentence stop Adora on her tracks.

— Yeah. What do you want to talk about? — Adora asked even though she could place two and two together and had a pretty good idea.

— I just want to check in with you… make sure we're okay. — Adora nodded. — So… are we?

The blonde got closer to hold Catra's hand.

— We're good on my part, I'm the one who should be asking that… you got home and you didn't kiss me, which I get it, stressful day. But then you say the thing about the tub as if it couldn't be anything other than a joke… and we haven't… exactly spent a lot of time being a couple these past two weeks.

Catra knew that was coming up.

— It's on me… I trying to figure out this whole living situation, I never had a partner living with me, and the way I operate in the house is as a mom. Is hard to turn it off. — She sighed. — I want you, you have to know that.

— So, come take a bath with me… I want to help you unwind from what happened in the office and is going to be nice… just a bath, nothing more.

Catra nodded and went for a hug. They went upstairs with silly smiles on their faces and Melog headed to sleep in Finn's room.

They hadn't seen each other completely naked since military school, in the last time the only thing missing was taking their underwear off and Catra did want to pressure it. So she took her shirt, pants and bra and waited to see what Adora was going to do.

The blonde stopped at the waistband.

— Do you want me to turn over? — Catra looked only ahead the entire time.

— No. It's okay. I'm comfortable being like this in front of you. — She said while sliding down the last piece of coverage. — You can look. — She held the little grin that was growing on her face.

Catra's response was purring and entering the water first, an act that was a bit of shock for Adora. Moments like that always made her realize how much they've grown.

— Are you staring? — Catra laughed as she slowly descended into the warm water while she tied her mane into a bun. — Just get in.

Adora step in and sat down, they were face to face, knees touching while they had their legs closed, each in a different side of the tub. They stare at each other in a bit sideways. It wasn't the most comfortable.

— Maybe you can lay on me? — Adora suggested because Catra was smaller.

— Right. — The feline switch position and fit perfectly in Adora's arms. — So this is nice.

— I never seen you this comfortable while soaked. — She could feel Catra's silent laugh. — What?! Oh… I get it.

— I'm sorry for being distant.

— No need, you told me it was hard to adapt… you have been so wonderful. I can't imagine being mad at you for needing time.

Catra took a deep breath.

— Finn's not home.

— They're not. — Adora confirmed not picking up on Catra was implying. — We can watch that movie that you wanted.

Catra took Adora's hands.

— Adora… — She whispered. — Can we go to the bedroom now?

Catra wanted to dry for what they had planned. Adora waited for Catra to get up.

— Do you need any help drying up?

Catra got out first and the view stole Adora's attention completely, she couldn't look away from the curves, even the wait her tail moved was fascinating. Catra grabbed a towel for her, and with a blush the other got out of the tub to be enveloped inside and wrapped herself in one too.

In the walk back to the room Adora was almost dry while Catra was nowhere near it. Catra did her best with the towel but soon the dryer was on. Adora didn't want to feel like they weren't at the same level so she didn't put any clothes on while sitting on the bed behind Catra to help dry her fur.

All she could think about was how Catra had missed such a thing for so long, not having the privilege of a dryer meant that most times she went to sleep with wet fur at some parts. No to mention how long it took for her mane to dry off. So Adora loved the idea of papering her girlfriend like that.

Catra offered her a brush as soon as she felt her fur puffing up.

— If you please. — Adora took it and her hands were shaky, leading her to almost let it fail on the bed. — It's everything okay back there?

— Yeah, my fingers huh, they're just a bit wet still so it slipped, but we're fine, very okie dokie. — Adora held a groan at her awkward response.

Catra kept still and melted under the care.

— When we were kids, I used to have a dream about this… first I was very little so I picture a parent, a mom. For the longest time I yearn for care like this. To be held. — She sounded bitter. — I never read any of it growing up and I guess I tried making it up

with Finn, giving them everything we didn't have. Sometimes it feels like I'm giving everything I got, everything. — She says a bit darkly. — I love them so much… but it's scary to think that… that maybe I need them, and someday they won't need me anymore.

Adora put the brush away to hold Catra.

— I think it is just your brain playing tricks on you… with all that happened in the past, you're work so hard to not be attached to anyone and then you decided to adopted them and now it's like you two are souls that were stitched together. — Adora whispered. — And you both need to learn to be on your own. People often think that kids are the ones who need to learn to be independent but parents too in a way. — Catra leaned back, melting yet again. — I see it a lot when the kids have their first day, and especially when they get hurt, the ache the parents feel to be needed, and I teach them to be more independent, to learn from their mistakes… it's okay and it's natural that you want to hang on tight.

The feline nodded, not really sure on what to say. She simply laid there feeling the warmth of Adora's body. Her tail wrapped around the strong leg.

— Do you want to go to sleep? — Her question somehow implied Catra had other things in mind.

— Not right now… do you? — The blonde was careful. Not completely sure on where they were headed.

— Right now, I kinda wanna kiss you. — Naked, was all Adora focused on. They were completely naked.

And for cuddling she was okay with it, she loved it even, but kissing? It made her hands tremble again just to think about it.

— Just kissing? — She couldn't start without knowing where the line was being drawn.

Catra turned around, and Adora's eyes betrayed her as they looked directly at her breasts.

— How does doing more than kissing sound to you? — Catra's hands started to caress right about Adora's knees.

— Interesting. — She was playing safe and trying to look Catra in the eyes. — I'm going to be honest, I was thinking about doing a lot more than kissing.

Catra kissed her, hands wandering around the blonde's curves. Pulling her by the waist to sit on her lap. Adora's hands were carefully put on the feline legs.

— Tell me your limit for today.

Adora looked deep into the odd eyes.

— Just keep going, I'll tell you if I need you to stop. — She pulled Catra for a kiss.

The feline willingly complied. A very soft kiss, a touch of the lips turned into an exploration of each other's mouth. Catra had to break the kiss to breathe, something Adora seemed to have forgotten she needed to do too. Slowly Catra touched Adora's breast while keeping eye contact. Adora decided to do like the last time and she started to mirror Catra. It was thrilling for the feline to know that, having Adora's hands on her felt so good, she played with the blonde's nipple, twisting slowly and rolling her eyes when Adora did the same.

— I can feel your heartbeat. — Catra whispered.

She slowly moved to replace her finger with her mouth. Adora was moaning and letting Catra do her thing until she felt the need to try it too, she softly pushed Catra up and soon her tongue was stroking gently against the feline's nipples.

Catra loved every second of it, feeling so lost in the pleasure that touching herself happened naturally. Her moans growing strong as her finger circled in nice pace. Adora felt the movement, she knew what Catra was doing, and like before she decided to mirror it. She let out a moan that made her nip at Catra's nipple, an accident that was rewarded with the loudest moan yet. Adora was

a lot more sensitivity than Catra, her rhythm slower with a nice pressure. Nothing like how hard Catra was rubbing herself.

Adora's body started to shiver. The whole situation felt like something out of her dreams.

— Ca-can I do it? — Adora asked, breathing hard.

Catra simply nodded to then lick her fingers, the sound of suction distracted Adora from what she set out to do. While still touching her self Adora started to explore Catra's folds, it was different touching someone else, she knew it would be, Catra felt warmer, her clit was hard and Adora could feel the throbbing against her palm. The act alone made her moan. She did her best to imitate Catra's speed and precision.

— Can I touch you? — Catra tried to wait but she wanted to touch her, to feel her completely.

— Ye-yes. — Adora gave her space. — Slowly, plea-se.

— Of course, my love.

As her hands traveled down Adora's body, she kissed her, trying to use it as a way for her girlfriend to relax. Her lips soft and full of care as she kissed Adora's cheek, jawline, her throat, collarbone.

The devotion in those acts took away any doubts Adora could've still have aboru what was about to happen.

And when finally Catra touched her, if felt right, it felt overdue. Adora was not ashamed of how she cried out. Not even when her hips started to move and her hand lost a bit for speed, because Catra was touching her, loving her, pleasuring her.

Catra knew what she was doing, very well but Adora was not falling too behind as her middle finger entered Catra while her thumb was still rubbing her clit.

It was so different for Catra to have someone that close while having sex, but it made everything so much better, she heard everything, she felt every movement, saw every time Adora had a full body goosebump. It was magical.

And to make it even more memorable, as soon as her body started to give strong signs of an orgasm so did Adora's. The blonde thrusted against Catra's hands non-stop and somehow still kept her finger moving.

Their moans were the only thing they heard for the next minute followed by two heavy breathings. Catra retrieved her finger slowly to not hurt Adora, who was laid out flat on the bed. Catra laid on top of her, purring.

— Thank you. — Adora let out as she hugged Catra. — I did not think I could do this.

— You don't have to thank me… — Catra chuckled. — You just needed a little push and a lot of patience. — Catra yawned.

— Let's sleep, you have a big meeting tomorrow. Better be rested. — Catra snuggled more on Adora's body as the blonde tried to reach the blanket.

— Yeah… big meeting.

Routine

One year & six months later

— So, how are things? — Perfuma handed Adora a vase, they were organizing the garden as they talked.

It had become a monthly meeting.

— Not great… Catra's job is a lot more demanding now that they are ready to start building, she needs to go there and talk through where they are going to build and what they are going to build. And she really wants to keep an eye out for Hordak. — She sighed. — So in a couple of days she's moving there. Temporarily but an undetermined temporary. And it's freaking me out because she wants me to take care of Finn. All by myself, and they're teenager now, do you know how terrifying they are?

— I have a teenage daughter, remember? I know how they are. — Adora put the vase down. — So you're scared you're going to be alone with them?

Adora nodded.

— She is their mom, and as much as I'm around, is not the same… I don't think they see me like that. — She went back to grab another vase. — It's like… the other day, Finn and Catra

were having a minor disagreement, and I knew how to solve it but I didn't feel like I could say anything. Like I wasn't allowed to have an opinion in family matters.

— Is that something that the two of them make you feel? Like you're not family.

— No… but I never had one, I don't know how to insert myself in that world. — She sighed again. — And clearly Catra trusts me, Finn was on board too… and is just scary, if I fuck this up, it's proof that I can't really do this and all this time was just me being lucky.

Perfuma calmly grabbed a vase a lot smaller than Adora's.

— What you're saying sounds a lot like imposter syndrome. — Adora looked at her, confused. — You do things with extreme self doubt, and even when you're good at them you think you're just fooling everyone into thinking you're good at it. — Adora was listening. — For what I gathered, that's how you feel, like you're fooling the two of them into thinking you're a family member.

The silence meant Adora was thinking.

— How do I fix it? — She asked.

— You need to believe in yourself. — Adora responded with one of her loud groans.

— Of course.

X

It was still weird to walk around and not see anyone or anything. The place she grow up in trying to be as new as it could be, trying to become something great, something better and had been caught somewhere between change.

Catra felt despair growing more and more each day. Not knowing if they would ever achieve their goals, it was all too much sometimes, all still so far from completion. And it was taking it's toll on her. And having Hordak around didn't help. Entrapta was the one actually around him all the time, they worked side by side to help heal the damage that he helped cause.

And oh how she was sick and tired of meeting people that said they were interested and proceeded to never contact her again.

It had been a month away from home, away from Finn and Adora and all the calls in the world could not do justice to being around them again. And it was worse with Adora, because she and Finn had such a long and stable relationship, they knew what to say and how to show Catra they were fine and it was okay for her to

stay a little longer but Adora, she sounded so dishonest when saying she was fine and what could Catra do?

And it was so scary to think she might finally say it was all too much, that she couldn't deal with being a parent or staying home and cooking, helping with homeworks, having to scold them. It was another growing feeling Catra had. She wanted to believe Adora, to believe she could do it and she did, she knew Finn loved her, and she knew Adora loved Finn. However they had never been in that situation before, ever, not like this, because it wasn't babysitting anymore, it was parenting.

Finn was in such a crucial moment in life, having small outbursts, dealing with new feelings, understanding a lot more of the world, the good and the bad. And they needed someone to lean on, and at the moment it was Adora, it has to be her.

— Catra…— Scorpia called. — Everything alright? I'm ready to show you where we are thinking of building the first housings. — Catra nodded and followed the bigger woman. — These will be for the ones who lost their home when the Fright Zone was doomed inhabitable. — She nodded once again, taking a nice look. — We discussed and thought having it close to the lake was a good idea.

— I agree. We can build a park for the kids. — Scorpia smiled. — How many are thinking?

— Since they will be fairly small, we're thinking 30 around here and another 30 on a different part yet to be determined. — She

walked back to their cars. — We have a lot of land purposed for cultivation and planting so the goal is not to have a lot of housing in one place. Scattering them makes for a more green friendly choice. So a lot of space between each house and a lot more space between each settlement.

— I wonder who is giving you environmental tips. — Catra said slowly.

It was fun messing with Scorpia. But the subject had become a bit of a mine field. After a disastrous first date Scorpia had to go back to work and somehow she and Perfuma ended up being close friends. Friends.

— Can you drop it please? — Scorpia quietly asked. Her perfect posture grew recoiled.

Catra got closer but didn't touch.

— I just don't get it… you obviously like her. Even asked her out for… tea. And because of one bad date you're just not going to try again? You? giving up so easily.

— It's been more than a year and she hasn't asked, plenty of time to try and reschedule but nothing! — She exasperated.

— I don't know… you didn't, maybe she thought it was it.

Scorpia started to walk faster.

— Moving on. The lake. We need to put up some warnings and make sure people don't drown.

Catra couldn't believe she was being ignored. But she didn't want to piss off the only person there she had to talk.

x

Adora didn't know what to do. Finn had invited friends and she simply didn't know what to, or how to talk to teens. Her students were all so disciplined and polite. And Finn's friends weren't bad but they also weren't Finn. She said it was fine and they were all hanging out next to some trees in front of their house.

She was so lost she didn't know what snacks to bring them or if she should bring snacks. It was killing her. And Finn was no help at all, they didn't say one thing other than ' friend's are coming over'. She had promised to call Catra when something was wrong, nothing was wrong but she definitely needed help. Although at the same time did she really wanted to freak out in front of Catra and risk her never letting Adora take care of Finn again.

She took a deep breath and followed her best instincts, deciding to leave them be until she was needed. They all knew how to

behave and Finn had good taste for friends, most of the time. Adora had chores to do, laundry, cleaning up after Melog's mess, who was not adapting well to not having Catra around and was shredding a lot of clothes and bedsheets. And she also needed to cut the grass.

Melog was another thing the blonde tried to not talk too much about with Catra. Not waiting to worry her too much. The blonde was minutes away from getting too much in her head when Finn opened the door. They gave her a brief nod before going into the kitchen to grabbed snacks. Adora opened her mouth to say something but she never got the chance to say as they already had left the house.

She felt like she was failing, miserably failing.

The rest of the day she simply stayed inside, going through her calendar, crossing out the days, counting how many they had to go through without Catra, marking the events, freaking out over Finn's birthday approaching, making sure to include the monthly shopping spread, and the few school events they had ahead of them. It was a bit of a packed month in her eyes. And she didn't know how or if she was going to handle it well.

Soon it was time to prepare dinner and that was her least favorite moment of the day. Finn wasn't a picky eater but they never seemed to truly enjoy Adora's cooking and she didn't know what to do about it and she couldn't spend the entire time ordering food.

To save herself some dignity she put on earphones as the cooking tutorial played out. She had definitely improved thanks to them and yet her food was still lacking in the flavor deportment.

— Adora! — Finn's voice scared the blonde making her drop her phone and thus revealing what she was watching. — You're watching a tutorial?... Why? — Finn had completely forgotten what they initially wanted.

— No…yes? I just needed a few tricks and tips. I've got this though, don't worry.

Finn eyed her for a while.

— I can help. — Adora didn't want help from a 13 year old. She truly didn't. — Mom used to make this sauce a lot. I think I remember most of it. — Finn got taller, Adora noticed as they passed her, a milestone she felt sad to know Catra was missing. — That's the wrong pan, Adora…here. — They handed her one smaller than the one she planned on using. — It heats up fast so we have to do it quickly.

Adora ended up following their lead. It was nice, and cozy after she let go of the sense of embarrassment clawing her gut. They were helping, they wanted to. It was a good thing. And Adora was not a failure for not knowing how to do some over complicated sauce.

They handled themselves like a pro, Adora was smiling proudly without being able to hold back.

— Have you talked to your mom today? — Finn's ears went flat at the question. — I know you've been hanging out with your friends and are now helping me, but you have to talk to her, you know she misses you.

— Does she really. — Finn mumbled.

— Hey… what's this about? — Adora got closer and turned off the stove. — You said you were okay with it yesterday… what changed?

Finn turned to face the wall.

— She won't be here for my birthday, Adora!

— We don't know that. She can drive here to see you. — Finn sniffed. — Is okay to miss her, but don't get mad at her for something she didn't do.

They sniffed harder. Adora hugged them, getting a tail wrapped around her legs.

— The sauce is ready.

x

It had been the first time Finn hadn't call, Adora had been extremely vague about why. Catra was worried to say the least. Why wouldn't her child call her? Was she such a terrible mom?

Catra kept torturing herself over it until nightfall, going through files while on the verge of tears. No clue what to do but to call Adora, she noted it was late, very late, she didn't want to wake up the blonde, who she knew was definitely already asleep. So she settled for a message saying good night. It was hard keeping a good relationship through the phone, especially when she didn't even had time to dedicate herself to it. She scroll their conversations to see how mundane it was, all good morning and good night, reassuring I love yous. Even their calls were short. It was frustrating, to see her work take so much and yet Adora was there to support her, telling her how important her work was.

She had at least 3 more months in front of her. 3 more months away from home, and only 6 days to visit them. She was working so hard to be able to see Finn on their birthday. The constructions were set to start on the beginning of the next month, only 5 days away. She crossed another day in her calendar and tossed herself onto bed.

Morning was as it always was, the worst. She stretched, yawned and then almost jumped out of her bed.

— What are you doing here?! — Catra exasperated to Entrapta, who was standing in front of her bed.

— Waiting for your alarm to go off. I have something exciting to show you! Get ready! I'm waiting for you outside.

Catra was sick of the lack of privacy, Entrapta knew the password to all of their rooms, it was beyond being annoying. Catra tried to breathe and calm herself before starting her day. After bathing and getting dressed she pulled her covers to start doing her bed, she was a bit shocked to find her sheets in poor condition, meaning, she didn't expect to see the shredded parts nor the claw marks all over it. She took a look at her fingernails, wondering why would she do that in her sleep again?

Another interruption from Entrapta forced her to forget about it for the next few hours. She had work to do.

— Is this about you wanting permission to perform a fake earthquake to make sure the ground is solid enough? — Catra asked as she entered her car.

— Well, three decades ago mining was a big deal here, it was the Horde's doing. What if we are standing in a land that's filled with holes just waiting to suck us in?! — She started. — But no. Not about that, not this time.

— So what is it?

— Have to show you. Just go to my lab please, I promise you, Hordak isn't there. — Catra turned to her, a bit frustrated.

— Where is he then? — She felt her claws dig into the rubber of her car wheel. — You know that he is not supposed to be wandering around.

— He is with Scorpia. Helping choose the materials for the construction of the houses. — She said simply. — I know you don't trust him, you made it very clear.

— Jeez, I wonder why.

Entrapta gave her a few seconds of eye contact.

— It's because of the unfathomable amount of trauma he caused you. Even if it was a factor he didn't consider happening.

— That's because he didn't care about anyone, and I doubt very much he does now. — Another few seconds of eye contact. — I still can't believe I let you and Glimmer talk me into hiring him.

— But look how much progress we made. — Entrapta had become more passionate about the project than Catra had ever expected her to. — We haven't failed you yet, so there's no reason for distrust.

Catra took a deep breath, deciding she was not going to talk for the rest of the ride, something that didn't seem to bother Entrapta.

She tried her best to bury her feelings, to not show anger, or resentment, or annoyance. It had become harder to hide her feelings after therapy, liying used to be her default mode and it changed and then she grew and decided to try and be a better person. At the moment she just hoped Entrapta's idea wasn't a robot, again.

— What am I looking at? — She inquired as politely as possible.

— The newest construction technology. I have enough prototypes for it to be test with the first houses, and I promise you it can't cause any harm if it doesn't work. — Catra kept staring at the overalls in front of her. — They're meant to help you carry 80% of your own weight. So even though we are short on people, we can make it up with strength.

— We have to talk to Scorpia, if she agrees, I… won't be on the way. — Entrapta jumped and did a little dance, soon leaving the small lab without saying a word to Catra. — It can't hurt.

Catra phone vibrated, she pick up without looking at the screen.

" I heard a little brat is back in town. "

Catra's mouth closed instantly, It had been years since she last talked to Double Trouble.

— Uh. Hi. — She tried to sound normal. — Yeah… is work. But how did… how did you?

" I have my contacts… where exactly are you staying, I think you and I have to talk business. "

— We do?

" Yes, we do. "

Catra gulped, she didn't know why, but still sensed something bad was going to happen.

— She said she wants to give it a try! — Entrapta entered the lab and Catra took another deep breath. — We can test it today. Just give me 30 minutes and meet me by the lake.

Catra nodded and went to find Scorpia. It wasn't hard to find her, somehow finding time to water the plants around their compound.

— A little water for you, a little water for you and for you. — Catra held back a smile.

— Did you for some unknown reason told Double Trouble we were here. — Scorpia turned, looking guilty. — I knew it.

— They're our friend. Why can't I talk to them?

— Trouble is literally in the name! — It was not going to make anything better if she simply lashed out. — Let's go. We have to see if the suit works.

Scorpia nodded. Catra tried to not think too much about it, to not read into it, it was just a call, nothing to worry about.

She had never felt so lost in her life as she did when she was around Double Trouble, right or wrong were not much of a thing to them and Catra could get easily swept into that mindset. It reminded her of so many mistakes.

She missed Adora more than ever.

— I hope it's fireproof this time. — Scorpia commented as they left to see the project.

X

Adora was stressed, so the punching bag was getting more attention than usual, her arms were aching and her sweat was making a mess of the floor. It was hot in the garage and no fan could fix that, she had tried.

She checked her clock again, Adora was having some regrets about her vacation, being away from work sounded like an excellent idea so she could take good care of Finn but it gave her too much time and it made it even worse to think that even with extra time she still sucked as a parent.

Finn was barely talking to her, they would see their friends and go to their room. Dinner was the only constant interaction and she was always so afraid to say the wrong things which meant making conversation was getting harder.

Her music was rudely interrupted by a call. No name but the number looked familiar so she picked-up. The call was short, she needed to go see the principal, Finn had gotten into a fight.

Adora was torn, it was clearly Catra's work time and it was also her child. The urgency made her postpone contacting Catra. A

decision she was not sure was the best, but it was all she had at that moment.

She had no idea what exactly she was getting into, or how she was going to handle any of it. But she was there, knocking on the principal's door, smelling like a humid garage and an exaggerated amount of deodorant.

— Hi, you must be Finn's guardian. — The lady spoke and Adora felt like she was the one in trouble.

— Yeah. Hi.

— Oh, I know you, you are at the museum! She-ra! — The excitement was soon disguised by a fake cough. — Sorry, I called you here because Finn got into a huge fight. They're at the infirmary, to make sure they're fine and so it's the boy they hit. — Adora tried not to panic.

— Are they alright?!

— Yes, nothing too bad, nothing broken, thankfully. — They stared at Adora for a second before continuing. — So, it's common for kids to rebel at this age, but Finn has always been a model student here despite their… origins. — Adora frowned. — We don't like to feed into prejudice here but Finn's violent behavior was something we feared.

— Finn's origins? — Adora spoke as calmly as she could manage. — I have the same origins, and you were seconds from asking me for an autograph. I'm taking Finn home, and you, and this prejudiced school can start fearing my violent behavior.

Adora got up, not really caring what the fight was about, not really caring if Finn could end up expelled. It was not worth it, they deserved better than that place. So Adora stormed into the infirmary, she grabbed Finn, who was in mint condition and dragged them out of the school.

— Did you call mom? — Was the first thing they said. — Please don't tell her!

— I haven't, but I will. — Adora said not caring too much about how angry and scared Finn looked. — What the fuck were thinking?! Getting into a fight?

— It's not like that! — They said. — I-I don't know what happened, really. — Adora looked at them again and noticed there was a trace of blood on their knuckles. — It was the same asshole! That fucking bully!

— Hey, no cursing. — They looked at her as if they couldn't believe she was scolding them about that. — Calm down and tell me what happened. It is a long way home, so spit it out.

Walking was going to be good for both so Adora figured it was the best option.

— Fine. This butthead that wrote me a bunch of stupid shit that last time was throwing trash at someone, I didn't really know the girl but I couldn't just stand by. And I swear my first instinct was to talk. I was going to talk to them but fuck they just said something so fuck up and I was punching him before I could think better of it, okay?!

Adora took a deep breath.

— You're grounded. — Finn gasped and groaned. — You're cleaning the bathroom for the next entire month. And tomorrow morning we are going hiking. At 6 in the morning.

Another groan. They walked in silence for a moment.

— Can I be the one to tell mom? — Finn asked. — Please, I don't want her thinking I'm hiding it from her, she's already going to be mad enough I asked them to call you instead of her.

Adora didn't know how to feel, it made sense for Finn to fear his mom more than her but it sounded like she was more of a friend than a guardian.

— Sure. But you're calling her as soon as we get home. — Finn looked distraught but Adora really didn't care at that moment which made her feel like a terrible guardian and then it passed and all she did was care. — Are you okay?

Finn was almost their mom's height, it made them look so mature and so young still.

— I don't know. I don't want to talk to mom… I didn't- I didn't call her last night and now I'm just going to say I fucked up at school!

Adora sighed.

— Why didn't you call her?

— Because I'm angry, Adora! — Finn almost screamed. — And miss her.

X

Work was hectic as usual. Scorpia was convinced the suits worked and the test drive was going well, which meant Catra needed to adjust their calendar and to advance some shipments and that meant a lot of calls. So when Finn's name popped up on her other phone she didn't realize it was them when she picked-up.

" Are you there, mom? "

— Finn? — Catra could tell something was wrong, Finn never sounded like that when things were okay. — What happened? Are you okay?

" Yep, I am… but this other kid from school, not so much. "

It took Catra some minutes, but she got there.

— A fight, Finn? Why would you get into a fight?

" It doesn't matter why, I'm sorry, Adora is handling school and she already grounded me. "

— Why didn't the school call me? — A new dread fell on Catra's shoulder, she started to check her calls to make sure the school really didn't call.

" I asked for Adora. "

And Catra felt the dread settle on her stomach like a punch. Finn asked for Adora. They were in trouble and they wanted Adora

there.

She wanted to ask why but she feared the answer too much.

— Okay. I'll talk to her later. — Finn didn't hang up so Catra didn't hang up. She could hear them breathing on the other side, a very subtle sniff made her tear up. — I love you.

" I-I love you. Bye mom."

Finn was crying, and she couldn't hug them. They needed her and she wasn't there.

Her phone started to ring like crazy seconds after the call. Another construction company. So Catra went back to work.

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